

SURVEY REPORT

Emerging Trends in Low-Code Development

A Data-Driven Study on Adoption Patterns, Innovation Drivers, and the Future of Visual Application Development

Name: Rinu Swetha

Roll No: 241401081

Dept: CSBS

About the Survey

Introduction, objectives, and scope of the study

Why This Study Matters

Low-code and no-code platforms have shifted from tactical departmental tools to core enterprise infrastructure. As organisations race to digitise operations while facing an acute shortage of skilled developers, visual, drag-and-drop application platforms are increasingly used to close the delivery gap between business demand and IT capacity. This survey was conducted to capture how students, working professionals, and citizen developers currently perceive, use, and plan to adopt low-code tools such as Zoho Creator, OutSystems, Mendix, and Microsoft Power Apps.

Survey Objectives

- Identify the emerging technology trends shaping low-code platforms in 2026.
- Assess current adoption levels across industries, roles, and organisation sizes.
- Evaluate perceived benefits, barriers, and governance concerns of low-code use.
- Recommend strategic actions for effective, secure low-code adoption.

212 valid responses formed the basis for every statistic presented in this report.



SURVEY TYPE

Mixed-Method
(Quantitative + Qualitative)



DURATION

6 Weeks
(Jan – Feb 2026)



COVERAGE

IT, BFSI, Education,
Healthcare & Retail sectors

Research Methodology & Demographics

How the survey was designed, distributed, and who responded

Methodology Snapshot

1

Design

A structured 22-item questionnaire covering awareness, usage, and sentiment was designed using Zoho Survey.

2

Distribution

Circulated via email, LinkedIn groups, and university/professional networks over a 6-week window.

3

Collection

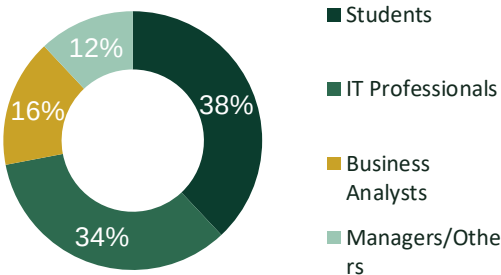
212 valid responses were collected from students and working professionals across five industries.

4

Analysis

Responses were cleaned and analysed using descriptive statistics and cross-tabulation techniques.

Respondent Profile (by Role)



212

Valid Responses

5

Industries Covered

81%

Aware of Low-Code Tools

The Global Low-Code Market Landscape

Industry-wide growth signals that frame the survey findings

~\$45B

Estimated global low-code market size in 2026

26–29%

Compound annual growth rate (CAGR) through 2030

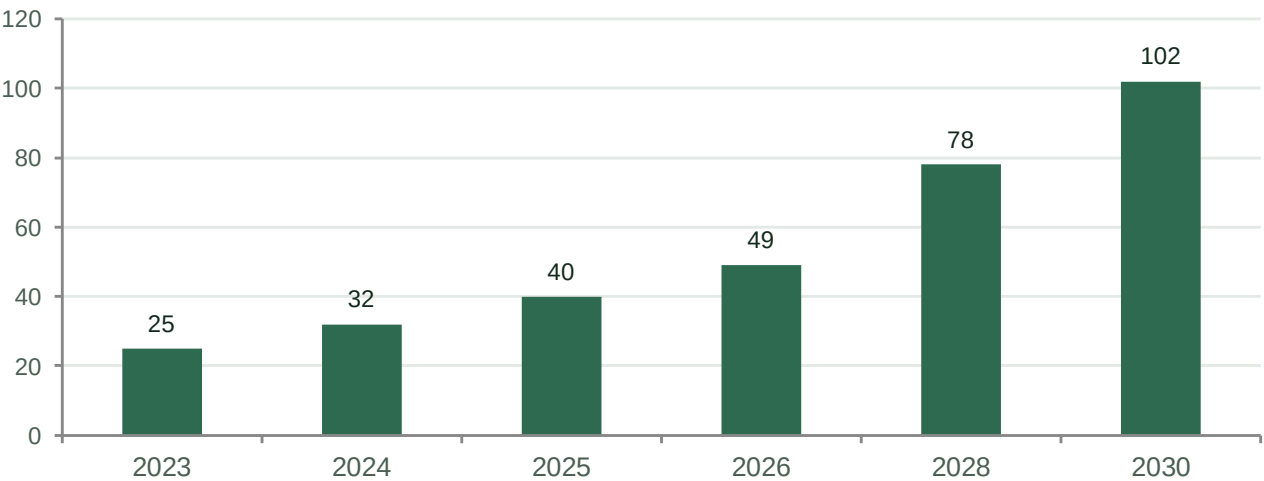
75%

Of new enterprise apps expected to use low-code by 2026

80%

Of low-code users projected to sit outside formal IT departments

Projected Market Size (USD Billion)

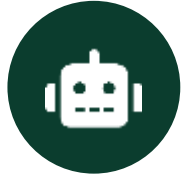


Key Market Drivers

- Persistent shortage of skilled professional developers
- Rising demand for rapid digital transformation
- Growing citizen-developer movement within enterprises
- Deep integration of generative AI into build tools
- Need to modernise legacy systems cost-effectively
- Push for faster, more agile IT service delivery

Emerging Trends — Part I

Intelligence and access are redefining who builds software



AI-Augmented Development

Generative-AI copilots embedded in low-code platforms now convert natural-language prompts into working data models, workflows, and UI screens — survey respondents rated AI assistance as the single most anticipated capability, cutting build cycles significantly.



Citizen Development Surge

Business users with little to no coding background are building their own departmental apps. Survey data shows a large share of respondents from non-IT roles have already created or plan to create an app without formal developer training.



Multi-Experience Development

Platforms increasingly let one visual model deploy simultaneously to web, mobile, tablet, and even conversational/chat interfaces, reducing duplicate design and development effort across channels.

Emerging Trends — Part II

Maturity is bringing enterprise-grade discipline to low-code



Low-Code + Pro-Code Convergence

Professional developers are extending low-code apps with custom scripts, APIs, and functions, blending visual tooling with hand-written code for complex logic — a "low-code plus" hybrid model favoured by IT teams surveyed.



Enhanced Governance & Security

As shadow IT risk grows, platforms now embed role-based access control, audit trails, and centralised admin dashboards. Governance was cited as a top adoption concern by respondents from regulated sectors such as BFSI and healthcare.



Vertical & Industry-Specific Platforms

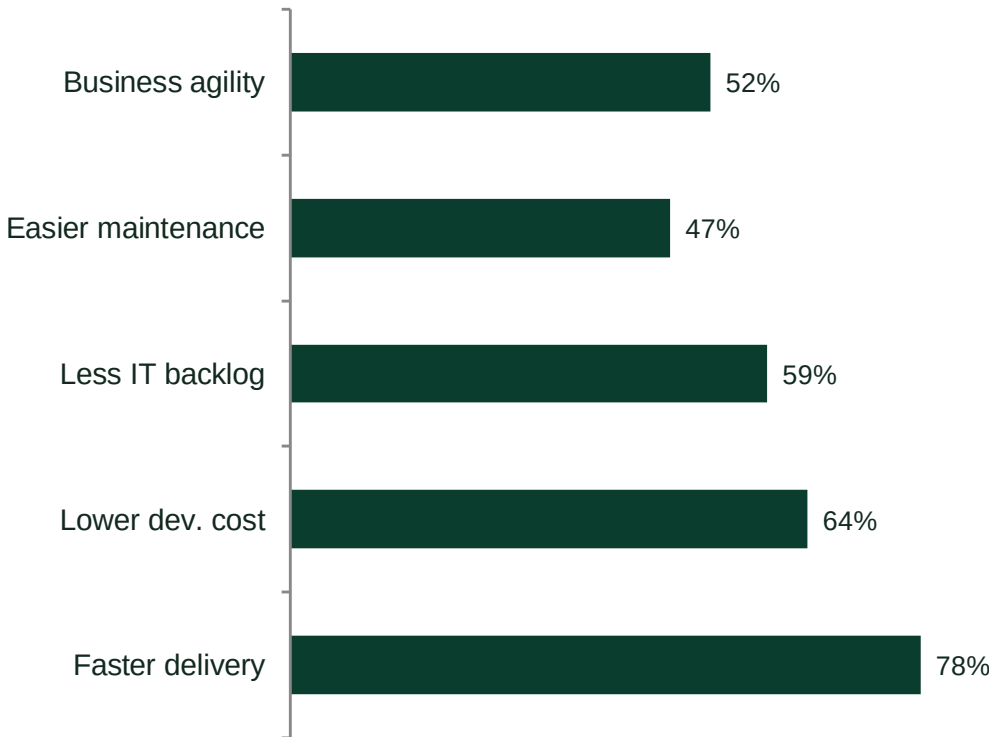
Purpose-built low-code solutions for healthcare, banking, and manufacturing are gaining traction, offering pre-built compliance templates and domain-specific connectors that shorten time-to-value.

Survey Findings: Benefits vs. Challenges

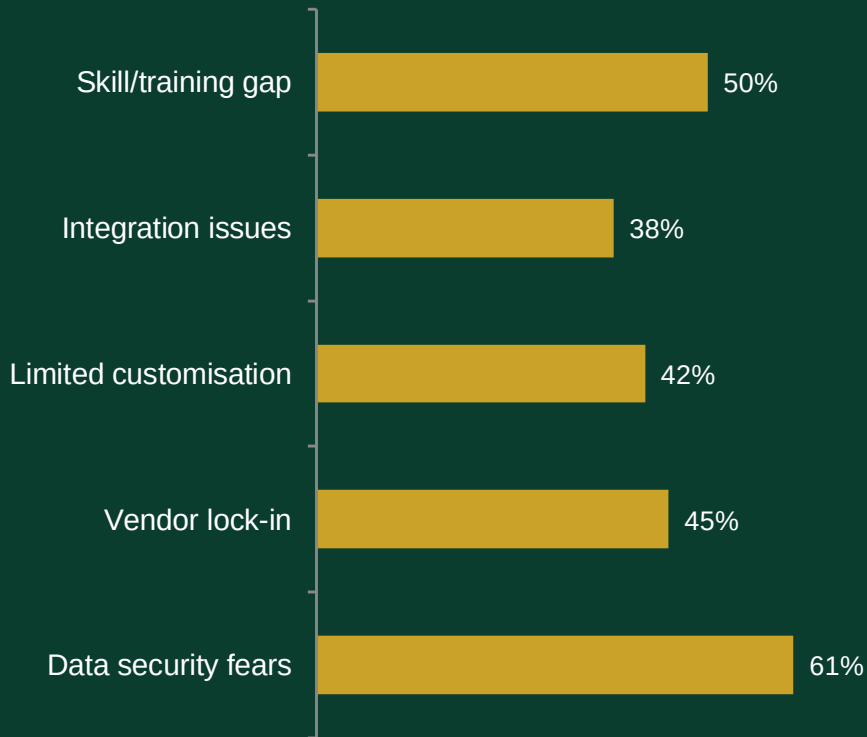
What respondents value most — and what still holds them back



Top Perceived Benefits



Top Adoption Challenges



Conclusion & Recommendations

Turning survey insights into an actionable adoption strategy

Key Takeaways

- Low-code adoption has moved from experimentation to strategic, board-level priority.
- AI-assisted, citizen, and multi-experience development are the three trends respondents expect to reshape workflows fastest.
- Security, governance, and integration remain the biggest barriers to scaling adoption safely.

Recommendations

- Establish a clear governance framework (access control, audit trails) before scaling citizen development.
- Invest in structured training so business users can build responsibly alongside IT.
- Pilot AI-assisted low-code features on low-risk internal workflows before mission-critical rollout.
- Choose platforms offering strong integration and low vendor lock-in for long-term flexibility.

212

Professionals & students surveyed

9

Emerging trends identified

**26–
29%**

Market CAGR through 2030